

NARA-prepared excerpt from "Consolidated Southeast Asia File Descriptions, Book III:

Appendix A: NMCS-HES Question Codes, Questions, and Responses."

Excerpt only includes questions related to VSSG; complete Appendix A available upon request.

From Appendix A: NMCS-HES QUESTION CODES, QUESTIONS, AND RESPONSES

The following ten questions supplied the data for the Vietnam Special Studies Group File (VSSG)

<u>CODE</u>	<u>DATA ELEMENTS AND VALUES</u>
HQB1	Which of the following most closely reflects the status of the enemy infrastructure in this hamlet? 0. No known or suspected infrastructure 1. Sporadic covert activity, little or no covert activity 2. Regular covert activity, sporadic overt activity generally at night 3. The primary authority in the hamlet at night, but most operate covertly in the day 4. The primary authority present day and night
HQC2	During daylight hours, do friendly local security forces conduct necessary security operations along approaches to this hamlet? (e.g. patrols, ambushes, listening posts, checkpoints, etc.) 0. No 1. Yes, but marginal 2. Yes, adequate 3. Not needed (no enemy threat)
HQC3	During hours of darkness, do friendly local security forces conduct necessary security operations along approaches to this hamlet? (e.g. patrols, ambushes, listening posts, checkpoints, etc.) 0. No 1. Yes, but marginal 2. Yes, but adequate 3. Not needed (no enemy threat)
HQC4	Are any hamlet households located in areas where agents, recruiters, tax collectors, and other cadre move about with relative freedom during hours of darkness? 0. No, none 1. Yes, a few (less than 10%) 2. Yes, some (10%-40%) 3. Yes, many (41%-90%) 4. Yes, all or nearly all
HQC5	Are any hamlet households located in areas where GVN administrative personnel are unable to move about with relative freedom during daylight hours? 0. No, none 1. Yes, a few (less than 10%) 2. Yes, some (10%-40%)

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3. Yes, many (41%-90%)
4. Yes, all or nearly all

HQE2 Is the GVN hamlet chief regularly present in this hamlet?

0. No
1. No, irregularly
2. Yes, regularly, but only by day
3. Yes, regularly day and night

VQE2 Are the members of the GVN Village Council elected to their posts by the people of this village?

0. No, no active Village Council exists
1. No, all Village Council members appointed
2. Yes, a few are elected (less than 30%)
3. Yes, some are elected (30%-70%)
4. Yes, many are elected (more than 70%)
5. Yes, all are elected

HMB1 Do enemy forces physically control this hamlet?

0. No
1. Yes
2. Yes, defensive works have been constructed by enemy forces to establish a "combat hamlet"

HMB4 Were armed enemy military forces present in inhabited areas of this hamlet during this month?

0. No
1. Yes, once
2. Yes, sporadically
3. Yes, regularly

VMB1 What was the estimated size of the largest entry, local, or main force unit present in or near inhabited areas of this village at any time during the month?

0. None
1. Less than a platoon
2. About a platoon
3. About a company
4. A battalion or more

While the preceding questions comprised the input for the VSSG Category Algorithm, the file contains another question:

HQZ1 Based on guidance given below, is this hamlet urban or rural in nature? (See Urban/Rural Differentiation- Appendix I for explanation.)

0. Rural
1. Urban

This question HQZ1 provided the information for URBAN (position 27).

APPENDIX E

VSSG CONTROL CATEGORY ALGORITHM

Hamlets are placed in one or more of the ten VSSG Control Categories listed in Step 3, following the procedures contained in Steps 1-3.

Step 1

Determine the "Derived Indicator" using the "Question Response Table" for each of the following ten questions (from 3 months of data):

HQB1	HQE2
HQC2	VQE2
HQC3	HMB1
HQC4	HMB4
HQC5	VMB1

Step 2

Based on the indicators obtained in Step 1, determine to which of the Condition Groups the hamlet belongs using the "Condition Group Definition Table". Note that a hamlet may belong to some or all of the groups, or it may belong to none.

Group A	(GVN, Presence)
Group B	(Quarterly VC Veto Conditions)
Group C	(Monthly VC Hamlet Veto Conditions)
Group D	(Monthly VC Village Veto Conditions)
Group V	(VC Presence)
Group Z	(GVN Veto Conditions)
Group N	(One or More Questions Could Not Be Rated)

Step 3

Place each hamlet into one or more of the ten VSSG Control Categories by testing various combinations of the "Condition Groups" derived in Step 2. See "Category Definition Table".

Question Response Table

<u>Second Last Month</u>	<u>Last Month</u>	<u>This Month</u>	<u>Derived Indicator</u>	
ANY	ANY	0	0	6
ANY	ANY	1	1	6
ANY	ANY	2	2	6
ANY	ANY	3	3	6
ANY	ANY	4	4	6
ANY	ANY	5	5	6
ANY	0	8, 9	0	6
ANY	1	8, 9	1	6
ANY	2	8, 9	2	6
ANY	3	8, 9	3	6
ANY	4	8, 9	4	6
ANY	5	8, 9	5	6
0	8, 9	8, 9	0	6
1	8, 9	8, 9	1	6
2	8, 9	8, 9	2	6
3	8, 9	8, 9	3	6
4	8, 9	8, 9	4	6
5	8, 9	8, 9	5	6
8, 9	8, 9	8, 9	U	6
*	8, 9	8, 9	U	6
ANY	*	8, 9	U	6

Note: * denotes that the hamlet did not exist that month

Condition Group Definition TableGroup AAll of the following must hold:

HQC2 = 1, 2, 3
 HQC3 = 1, 2, 3
 HQE2 = 3
 HQC5 = 0, 1
 VQE2 = 2, 3, 4, 5

Group BOne or more of the following hold:

HQB1 = 2, 3, 4
 HQC4 = 3, 4

Group COne or more of the following hold:

HMB4 = 2, 3
 HMB1 = 1, 2

Group D

VMB1 = 3, 4

Group VOne or more of the following hold:

HMB1 = 1, 2
 HQB1 = 3, 4
 HQB1 = 2 AND HQC3 = 0
 HQB1 = 2 AND HQC3 = 1 AND HQC5 = 2, 3, 4

Group ZOne or more of the following hold:

HQC2 = 2, 3
 HQC3 = 2, 3
 HQE2 = 3

HQC5 = 0, 1

65

Group NOne or more of the following hold:

HQC2 = U
 HQC3 = U
 HQE2 = U
 HQC5 = U
 VQE2 = U
 HQB1 = U
 HQC4 = U
 HMB4 = U
 HMB1 = U
 VMB1 = U

Category Definition Table

<u>Category</u>	<u>Category Name</u>	<u>Condition Group Membership</u>
P	GVN PRESENCE	A
Q	INFLUENCED BY BOTH SIDES	(NOT A) AND (NOT N) AND (NOT
R	VC PRESENCE	V AND (NOT A)
S	COULD NOT BE RATED	N AND (NOT A) AND (NOT V)
T	GVN CONTROL	A AND (NOT B) AND (NOT C)
		AND (NOT D) AND (NOT N)
U	VC CONTROL	V AND (NOT Z)
V	GVN PRESENCE LESS	
	QUARTERLY VC VETO	A AND (NOT B)
W	MONTHLY VC HAMLET VETO	
	OF GVN CONTROL	A AND C AND (NOT B)
X	MONTHLY VC VILLAGE VETO	
	OF GVN CONTROL	A AND D AND (NOT B)
Y	GVN CONTROL VETOED BY	
	UNRATED VC QUESTIONS	A AND N AND (NOT B) AND
		(NOT C) AND (NOT D)

Excerpt from "Consolidated Southeast Asia File Descriptions, Book III: Appendix H: Tables Utilized by NMCS-HES." Excerpt only includes PROV Table; complete Appendix H available upon request.

Table PROV

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The PROV Table converts a two-character province code into the province name. Certain of these provinces include the name of an autonomous city.

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TABLE	PROV	02	18	OF	LEE	
01	QUANG TRI					3037
02	THUA THIEN/HUE					3038
03	QUANG NAM/DANANG					3039
04	QUANG TIN					3040
05	QUANG NGAI					3041
06	KONTUM					3042
07	BINH DINH					3043
08	PLEIKU					3044
09	PHU BON					3045
10	PHU YEN					3046
11	DARLAC					3047
12	KHANH HOA/CAM RANH					3048
13	NINH THUAN					3049
14	TUYEN DUC/DALAT					3050
15	QUANG DUC					3051
16	LAM DONG					3052
17	BINH THUAN					3053
18	BINH TUY					3054
19	LONG KHANH					3055
21	PHOUK LONG					3056
22	BINH LONG					3057
23	BINH DOUNG					3058
24	TAY NINH					3059
25	HAU NGHIA					3060
26	BIEN HOA					3061
27	PHUOC TUY/VUNG TAU					3062
28	LONG AN					3063
29	GIA DINH/SAIGON					3064
30	GO CONG					3065
31	KIEN TUONG					3066
32	KIEN PHONG					3067
33	DINH TUON					3068
34	KIEN HOA					3069
35	VINH BINH					3070
36	VINH LONG					3071
37	AN GIANG					3072
38	KIEN GIANG					3073
39	CHUONG THIEN					3074
40	PHONG DINH					3075
41	BA XUYEN					3076
42	AN XUYEN					3077
43	BAC LIEU					3078

Excerpt from "Consolidated Southeast Asia File Descriptions, Book III: Appendix H: Tables Utilized by NMCS-HES." Excerpt only includes PROV Table; complete Appendix H available upon request.

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3081

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Table 2 - Province Code List

	<u>PROV CODE</u>	<u>PROVINCE NAME</u>
I Corps	01	Quang Tri
	02	Thua Thien
	03	Quang Nam
	04	Quang Tin
	05	Quang Ngai
	91	Hue
	92	Da Nang
II Corps	06	Kontum
	07	Binh Dinh
	08	Pleiku
	09	Phy Bon
	10	Phy Yen
	11	Darlac
	12	Khnanh Hoa
	13	Ninh Thuan
	14	Tuyen Duc
	15	Quang Duc
	16	Lam Dong
	17	Binh Thuan
	93	Cam Ranh
	94	Dalat
III Corps	18	Binh Tuy
	19	Long Khanh
	21	Phuoc Long
	22	Binh Long
	23	Binh Duong
	24	Tay Ninh
	25	Hau Nghia
	26	Bien Hoa
	27	Phuoc Tuy
	28	Long An
	29	Gia Dinh
	95	Vung Tau
	96	Saigon
IV Corps	30	Go Cong
	31	Kien Tuong
	32	Kien Phong
	33	Dinh Tuong
	34	Kien Hoa
	35	Vinh Binh
	36	Vinh Long
	37	An Giang

PROV
CODE

PROVINCE NAME

38
39
40
41
42
43
44
46

Kien Giang
Chuong Thien
Phong Dinh
Ba Xuyen
An Xuyen
Bac Lieu
Chau Doc
Sa Dec

From the agency documentation for the Herbicide Data Files (HERBO-2), NN3-330-75-146

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E.O. 12958, Ex. 1 3.3

NND 023093

By 904Date 4-18-09ANNEXTHE VSSG CONTROL INDICATORS

Background. In October 1969 the Vietnam Special Studies Group (VSSG) began examining the statistical data bases being used to measure activities and results in Vietnam. Among the problems the VSSG considered was the fact that the Hamlet Evaluation System (HES) security indicator in common use was an amalgam of many security-related factors, but did not directly measure the essence of GVN control in the countryside. Hamlets could receive high security ratings, but still have enough VC presence in the hamlet to preclude effective GVN control.

Using the raw data provided in both the old HES and the revised HES (HES/70), the VSSG devised new indicators of GVN and VC control. The following sections describe the concepts and mechanics of the VSSG indicators developed for HES/70; similar methods were used for the old HES, but because of the nature of the raw data, the old HES VSSG results did not correlate as well with field reports of GVN control, and are described only briefly in this paper.

VSSG Control Concepts

The VSSG began with the assumption that a primary objective of both sides in the Vietnam conflict is to achieve control of the people and resources of the countryside. VSSG control indicators assign the population of a hamlet to GVN or VC control if the military and political strength of the GVN or VC control organization in that hamlet is sufficient to administer the hamlet effectively while preventing the other side from doing so. To make the indicators as strict and objective as possible, we assumed the following:

- The GVN requires both military strength (local security forces) and political and administrative organization (hamlet chief, village council, administrative personnel) to achieve control over hamlet resources. However, a single indicator of significant VC presence (armed enemy forces, regular covert VCI activity, significant nighttime access) can veto GVN control.

- The VC, on the other hand, can achieve control with a strong political organization alone (the VC infrastructure). The GVN can veto VC control with a strong military or political/administrative presence.

- The GVN can achieve control only when there is full local security provided: when a hamlet must rely primarily on external forces for defense, a key element of lasting control--local participation--is lost. External forces, therefore, cannot serve as a proxy for GVN military strength in the hamlet.

Table 1 shows how the above concepts were applied to construct the VSSG indicators from both the old HES and HES/71.

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By 4907 Date 4-10-89

TABLE 1

VSSG INDICATOR CONCEPTSOld HES (1967-1969)

Requires both GVN military and political/administrative strength to achieve GVN control.

Allows either of 2 VC/VCI presence indicators to veto GVN control:

- VC guerrilla strength and activity
- VC infrastructure intact and active

Allows friendly external forces as well as local security forces to provide the GVN military strength.

Requires both VC guerrilla and infrastructure strength to achieve VC control.

Allows single indicator of GVN presence to veto VC control.

HES/70 (July 1969-1970)

Requires both GVN military and political/administrative strength to achieve GVN control.

Allows any one of 5 VC/VCI presence indicators to veto GVN control:

- VC physical control of hamlet
- VC infrastructure intact and active
- Armed enemy force presence
- Enemy nighttime access to people
- Main/local force presence

Requires local security forces to provide the GVN military strength.

Requires only significant VC infrastructure strength to achieve VC control.

Allows single indicator of GVN presence to veto VC control.

The final step in constructing the indicators was to select a set of HES/70 questions which measured the VSSG control concepts in Table 1 as completely as possible. The set of questions was kept small (only 10 were finally selected) in order to make the indicator as simple and straightforward as possible. Table 2 shows which HES/70 questions were selected and how they are logically combined to measure the VSSG control concepts.

The VSSG indicator is normally applied only to rural population, since the control war is primarily rural in nature. Urban areas are usually assumed to be under GVN control.

Evaluation of the VSSG Indicators. Since the 10 HES/70 questions in the VSSG indicator are also used in the HES security score, it is not surprising that the VSSG indicators are highly correlated with HES security. The VSSG indicators are somewhat easier to interpret because of their concept and simplicity of design, however, and often provide insights into changes of control which the HES security score cannot provide directly.

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By NN DO23093
Date 4-10-89

TABLE 2
HES/70 VSSG CONTROL INDICATORS

GVN Control

VC Control

Group A - GVN Presence (All Required)

1. Local security forces conduct at least "marginal" security operations in daytime (e.g. patrols, ambushes, listening posts, checkpoints, etc.), or operations not needed (no enemy threat). HQC2 = 1,2,3
2. As above for night operations. HQC3 = 1,2,3
3. GVN hamlet chief regularly present day and night in hamlet. HQE2 = 3
4. GVN administrative personnel can move about with relative freedom during daylight hours in areas containing 91-100% of hamlet households. HQC5 = 0, 1
5. Some or all of Village Council members are elected. VQE2 = 2,3,4,5

Group B - Quarterly VC Veto Conditions (One or More Can Veto GVN Control)

1. Regular covert, sporadic overt activity by hamlet VCI; or hamlet VCI are primary authority in hamlet, at least at night. HQB1 = 2,3,4
2. Enemy agents, recruiters, tax collectors, etc. have access at night to 41-100% of hamlet households. HQC4 = 3,4

Group C - Hamlet Monthly VC Veto Conditions (One or More Can Veto GVN Control)

1. VC physically control the hamlet. HMB1 = 1,2
2. Armed enemy forces present more than once in hamlet this month. HMB4 = 2,3

Group D - Village Monthly VC Veto Condition

1. Company or more of enemy main/local forces present in or near inhabited areas of village this month. VMB1 = 3,4

Group V - VC Presence (One or More Required; GVN Presence Prohibited)

1. VC physically control the hamlet. HMB1 = 1,2
2. Hamlet VCI are primary authority in hamlet, at least at night. HQB1 = 3,4
3. Regular covert, sporadic overt activity by hamlet VCI (HQB1 = 2), and either of the following conditions hold:
 - a. Friendly local security activities are not conducted at all at night. HQC3 = 0
 - b. Friendly local security forces conduct only marginal security operations at night, and GVN daytime access is denied to 10% or more of hamlet households. HQC3 = 1 and HQC5 = 2,3,4

Group Z - GVN Veto Conditions (One or More Can Veto VC Control)

1. Local security forces conduct "adequate" security operations in daytime. HQC2 = 2,3
2. As above for night operations. HQC3 = 2,3
3. GVN hamlet chief regularly present day and night in hamlet. HQE2 = 3
4. GVN administrative personnel can move about with relative freedom during daylight hours in areas containing 91-100% of hamlet households. HQC5 = 0,1

Group N - Could Not Be Rated

One or more of the HES questions used in Groups A,B,C,D,V or Z were rated "not applicable" or "unknown/unable to judge" for three or more months.

Note that if a question is unanswered for only one or two months, the most recent response (two or three months old) is used.

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By YAY Date 4-10-89

The VSSG indicators have been checked at least initially against other recognized measures of GVN control in over a dozen provinces in South Vietnam. They seem to give a reasonable evaluation of both the extent of GVN control, and trends in control over time. Province-by-province and hamlet-by-hamlet data is available in hardcopy and magnetic tape formats to any analysts interested in using the VSSG data. Only additional study will be able to provide a complete evaluation of the merits of the indicators.

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OFFICE OF THE ASSISTANT SECRETARY OF DEFENSE
WASHINGTON, D. C. 20301

SYSTEMS ANALYSIS

(Regional Programs)

June 5, 1970

MEMORANDUM FOR DISTRIBUTION

SUBJECT: New VSSG Control Indicators from HES/70

I am enclosing the results of our work to date on developing new GVN and VC control indicators using data on rural hamlets from the revised Hamlet Evaluation System (HES/70). Our investigations were limited to one month of data (December 1969) for which we could compare results from both old and new VSSG indicators, and from both old and new HES A-B Security ratings.

There now appear to be two candidate indicators for consideration by the VSSG, one using strict conditions for determining GVN control, and one using more relaxed conditions. The difference between the two hinges on whether we require "adequate" day-night local security operations for GVN control, or whether we allow "marginal or better" operations. Both of these candidate indicators, however, appear to be conceptually more stringent than the old VSSG control indicators, and appear to meet some of the primary objections raised by VSSG province analysts to the old indicators.

Using the relaxed conditions for determining GVN control, we found the following:

-- Some 47.8% of the rural population in December 1969 were under GVN control, compared to 61.6% using the old VSSG GVN control indicator. Thus, use of the new indicator results in 13.8% less population under GVN control. (The strict criteria result in 36.7% GVN control, or 24.9% less than the old control indicator.)

-- The new GVN control indicator (using relaxed criteria) ranks the 12 VSSG study provinces in about the same ordering as did the old VSSG control indicator: 8 provinces were within one rank and 11 within two ranks of their ordering under the old indicator.

We are preparing to produce complete 10-month time series data (July 1969-April 1970) for all provinces using both of the new candidate indicators. With the concurrence of the VSSG Working Group, this data will be available to all VSSG study panels. The data should be considered as tentative, however, and I am particularly interested in obtaining evaluations from the province analysts themselves on the relative merits of the new indicators. Have we included all the most important facts the HES/70 provides on GVN control? Is the conceptual framework of the indicators satisfactory? And, most important, do the new indicators represent reality in the VSSG study provinces, at least in terms of trends over time?

Fred Leutner
Frederick D. Leutner

Step 3

Place hamlet into one or more of the following ten categories defined below by testing various combinations of Condition Group membership:

<u>Category</u>	<u>Category Name</u>	<u>Condition Group Membership(s)</u>
P	GVN Presence	A
Q	Influenced by Both Sides	(NOT A) AND (NOT M) AND (NOT V)
R	VC Presence	V AND (NOT A)
S	Could Not Be Rated	N AND (NOT A) AND (NOT V)

T	GVN Control	A AND (NOT B) AND (NOT C) AND (NOT D) AND (NOT N)
U	VC Control	V AND (NOT Z)

V	GVN Presence Less Quarterly VC Veto	A AND (NOT B)
W	Monthly VC Hamlet Veto of GVN Control	A AND C AND (NOT B)
X	Monthly VC Village Veto of GVN Control	A AND D AND (NOT B)
Y	GVN Control Vetoed by Unrated VC Questions	A AND N AND (NOT B) AND (NOT C) AND (NOT D)

Note that, because sets P, Q, R, and S are mutually exclusive and exhaustive, the hamlets (and population) in these four categories must add up to the total hamlets (or population) in the data base considered.

VSSG CONTROL CONCEPTS

A primary objective of both sides in the Vietnam conflict is to achieve control of the people and resources of the countryside. We designed a "VSSG Control Indicator" which assigns the population of a hamlet to GVN or VC Control only if the military and political strength of the GVN or VC control organization in that hamlet is sufficient to effectively administer the hamlet, while preventing the other side from doing so. In designing the indicator, we assumed that:

-- The GVN requires both military strength (local security forces) and political and administrative organization (hamlet chief, village council, administrative personnel) to achieve control over hamlet resources, but that even a single indicator of significant VC presence (armed enemy forces, regular covert VCI activity) can veto GVN control. The VC can deny control to the GVN merely by asserting their presence in a hamlet which GVN forces occupy.

-- The VC, on the other hand, can achieve control of people and resources in the countryside with their political organization alone (the VC infrastructure), even without evidence of a strong military presence at the same time. The VCI organization is so effective that the GVN can veto its control only with its full military and political/administrative presence (not organization).

-- The GVN can achieve control only when there is full local security provided: when a hamlet must rely primarily on external forces for defense, a key element of lasting control--local participation--is lost. External forces, therefore, cannot serve as a proxy for GVN military strength in the hamlet.

The above assumptions differ from those used to construct the old VSSG control indicators, as the table below shows. The differences are such that the new VSSG indicators are inherently more strict, and should show somewhat less GVN control and somewhat more VC control than the old VSSG indicators. The changes should lead to a more objective assessment of the control situation, however, and should account for the findings of the province analysts in the Situation in the Countryside paper that the old control indicators tended to understate the strength of the VCI.

COMPARISON OF OLD VS. NEW
INDICATOR CONCEPTS

Old Control Indicators

Requires both GVN military and political/administrative strength to achieve GVN control.

Allows single indicator of VC presence to veto GVN control

* Allows friendly external forces as well as local security forces to provide the GVN military strength.

* Requires both VC guerrilla and infrastructure strength to achieve VC control.

* Allows single indicator of GVN presence to veto VC control.

New Control Indicators

Requires both GVN military and political/administrative strength to achieve GVN control.

Allows single indicator of VC presence to veto GVN control.

Requires local security forces to provide the GVN military strength. *

Requires only VC infrastructure strength to achieve VC control. *

Requires indicators of both GVN military and political/administrative presence to veto VC control. *

1967-1969 VSSG CONTROL INDICATORS

(Old Hamlet Evaluation System)

GVN Control

Group A - GVN Presence (All Required)

1. Hamlet Defense Plan and Organization (minimum condition): "local warning and communication systems operative; some armed local defenders but main reliance on PF and/or RD team or external defense." Ind. 3A = A,B,C (If a D rating was made, then GVN presence was still allowed if Friendly External Force Assistance was rated A - "need for friendly external forces very slight, can be met adequately.") Ind. 3A = D and Ind. 3B = A
2. GVN Governmental Management (minimum condition): "complete managerial group fully resident includes hamlet chief; fully functioning but with some external support such as RD team or other GVN workers." Ind. 4A = A,B

Group B - Veto Conditions (One or More Can Veto GVN Control)

(See Group X under "VC Control")

VC Control

Group X - VC Presence (All Required)

1. Village Guerrilla Units: either "village guerrillas reduced somewhat in men and defenses; can attack in platoon strength from within village or 1-2 hours travel to hamlet" or "village guerrillas combat effective though some identified and eliminated; VC village defenses largely intact" or hamlet is VC controlled. Ind. 1A = D,E, VC (If a C rating was made, VC presence was still allowed if VC External Forces were rated D,E, or VC - "may have base and can make company-size attacks within a few hours travel to hamlet; hamlet or village may have been fired on and/or assaulted during month.")
2. Hamlet Infrastructure: either "members and most leaders of VC hamlet organizations uncovered and neutralized but hamlet undercover agents still operative" or "party cadre underground by day but free to intimidate populace by night; no assurance party structure or leaders uncovered" or hamlet is VC controlled. Ind. 2A = D,E,VC

Group Y - Veto Conditions (One or More Can Veto VC Control)

(See Group A under "GVN Control")

HES/70 VSSG CONTROL INDICATORS
(Strict Criteria)

GVN Control

Group A - GVN Presence (All Required)

1. Local security forces conduct "adequate" security operations in daytime (e.g. patrols, ambushes, listening posts, checkpoints, etc.), or operations not needed (no enemy threat). HQC2 = 2,3
2. Local security forces conduct "adequate" security operations at night (e.g., patrols, ambushes, listening posts, checkpoints, etc.) or operations not needed (no enemy threat). HQC3 = 2, 3.
3. GVN hamlet chief regularly present day and night in hamlet. HQE2 = 3
4. GVN administrative personnel can move about with relative freedom during daylight hours in areas containing 91-100% of hamlet households. HQC5 = 0,1
5. Some or all of Village Council members are elected. VQE2 = 2,3,4,5

Group B - Hamlet Level Veto Conditions
(One or More Can Veto GVN Control)

Either condition in Group X under "VC control," and/or any of the following can veto GVN control:

1. Armed enemy forces present more than once in hamlet this month. HMB4 = 2,3
2. Regular covert, sporadic overt activity by hamlet VCI. HQB1 = 2
3. Enemy agents, recruiters, tax collectors, etc. have access at night to 41-100% of hamlet households. HQC4 = 3,4

Group C - Village Level Veto Condition

1. Company or more of enemy main/local forces present in or near inhabited areas of village this month. VMB1 = 3,4

VC Control

Group X - Primary Conditions (Either Condition Places Hamlet Under VC Control)

1. VC physically control the hamlet. HMB1 = 1,2
2. Hamlet VCI are primary authority in hamlet at night. HQB1 = 3,4

Group Y - Secondary Conditions (Can Place Hamlet Under VC Control Even If Primary Conditions Not Met)

A hamlet is rated VC Controlled if there is regular covert, sporadic overt activity by the hamlet VCI (HQB1 = 2), and either of the following conditions hold:

1. Friendly local security activities are not conducted at all at night. HQC3 = 0.
2. Friendly local security forces conduct only marginal security operations at night, and GVN daytime access is denied to 10% or more of hamlet households. HQC3 = 1 and HQC5 = 2,3,4

Group Z - Veto Conditions (All Are Required to Veto VC Control)

(See Group A under "GVN Control")

HES/70 VSSG CONTROL INDICATORS
(Relaxed Criteria)

GVN Control

Group A - GVN Presence (All Required)

1. Local security forces conduct at least "marginal" security operations in daytime (e.g. patrols, ambushes, listening posts, checkpoints, etc.), or operations not needed (no enemy threat). HQC2 = 1,2,3
2. Local security forces conduct at least "marginal" security operations at night (e.g., patrols, ambushes, listening posts, checkpoints, etc.) or operations not needed (no enemy threat). HQC3 = 1,2,3
3. GVN hamlet chief regularly present day and night in hamlet. HQE2 = 3
4. GVN administrative personnel can move about with relative freedom during daylight hours in areas containing 91-100% of hamlet households. HQC5 = 0,1
5. Some or all of Village Council members are elected. VQE2 = 2,3,4,5

Group B - Hamlet Level Veto Conditions
(One or More Can Veto GVN Control)

Either condition in Group X under "VC control," and/or any of the following can veto GVN control:

1. Armed enemy forces present more than once in hamlet this month. HMB4 = 2,3
2. Regular covert, sporadic overt activity by hamlet VCI. HQB1 = 2
3. Enemy agents, recruiters, tax collectors, etc. have access at night to 41-100% of hamlet households. HQC4 = 3,4

Group C - Village Level Veto Condition

1. Company or more of enemy main/local forces present in or near inhabited areas of village this month. VMB1 = 3,4

VC Control

Group X - Primary Conditions (Either Condition Places Hamlet Under VC Control)

1. VC physically control the hamlet HMB1 = 1,2
2. Hamlet VCI are primary authority in hamlet at night. HQB1 = 3,4

Group Y - Secondary Conditions (Can Place Hamlet Under VC Control Even If Primary Conditions Not Met)

A hamlet is rated VC Controlled if there is regular covert, sporadic overt activity by the hamlet VCI (HQB1 = 2), and either of the following conditions hold:

1. Friendly local security activities are not conducted at all at night. HQC3 = 0.
2. Friendly local security forces conduct only marginal security operations at night, and GVN daytime access is denied to 10% or more of hamlet households. HQC3 = 1 and HQC5 = 2,3,4

Group Z - Veto Conditions (All Are Required to Veto VC Control)

(See Group A under "GVN Control")

PROPOSED VSSG INDICATOR DATABASED ON RURAL POPULATION - DECEMBER 1969

	<u>Binh Thuan</u>	<u>Dinh Tuong</u>	<u>Long An</u>	<u>Binh Dinh</u>	<u>Kien Hoa</u>	<u>Quang Nam</u>
<u>1967-69 VSSG Indicators</u>						
GVN Control	32.5	44.8	45.6	46.9	49.8	56.9
VC Control	4.8	11.7	12.9	4.8	30.9	7.4
<u>1970 "Strict" VSSG Indicators</u>						
GVN Control	<u>23.9</u>	<u>12.6</u>	<u>36.8</u>	<u>25.1</u>	<u>33.6</u>	<u>31.7</u>
GVN Presence - Vetoed by						
B Only	2.6	2.3	9.6	5.9	6.4	2.0
- Vetoed by						
C Only	3.2	5.0	6.4	12.0	2.1	8.1
- Vetoed by B						
and C	<u>.1</u>	<u>.3</u>	<u>0</u>	<u>6.9</u>	<u>.4</u>	<u>0</u>
Subtotal (GVN Presence)	29.8	20.2	52.8	49.9	42.5	41.8
VC Control	2.2	26.6	7.3	8.7	27.3	7.9
<u>1970 "Relaxed" VSSG Indicators</u>						
GVN Control	31.3	22.3	47.7	27.3	37.8	41.1
GVN Presence - Vetoed by						
B Only	16.2	7.3	13.8	10.4	14.1	6.5
- Vetoed by						
C Only	5.3	8.8	6.8	14.7	3.0	9.3
- Vetoed by B						
and C	<u>3.9</u>	<u>5.0</u>	<u>.7</u>	<u>11.1</u>	<u>2.8</u>	<u>.6</u>
Subtotal (GVN Presence)	56.7	43.4	69.0	63.5	57.7	57.5
VC Control	1.1	26.2	7.3	7.7	26.6	7.6
<u>1967-69 HES</u>						
A - B Security	35.2	37.8	43.9	42.3	37.5	61.9
<u>1970 HES</u>						
A - B Security	<u>28.8</u>	<u>28.7</u>	<u>55.5</u>	<u>52.9</u>	<u>38.8</u>	<u>48.4</u>

PROPOSED VSSG INDICATOR DATABASED ON RURAL POPULATION - DECEMBER 1969

	<u>Chuong Thien</u>	<u>Chan Doc</u>	<u>Kontum</u>	<u>Thua Thien</u>	<u>Binh Duong</u>	<u>Khanh Hoa</u>
<u>1967-69 VSSG Indicators</u>						
GVN Control	58.0	62.6	67.4	75.2	81.2	98.3
VC Control	17.5	3.5	.8	0	1.3	0
<u>1970 "Strict" VSSG Indicators</u>						
GVN Control	<u>28.0</u>	<u>50.9</u>	<u>26.8</u>	<u>49.1</u>	<u>40.3</u>	<u>34.1</u>
GVN Presence - Vetoed by						
B Only	0	4.2	4.8	4.8	3.3	1.6
- Vetoed by						
C Only	14.8	4.9	.2	.6	4.3	0
- Vetoed by B & C	<u>3.1</u>	<u>3.5</u>	<u>12.7</u>	<u>2.8</u>	<u>1.1</u>	<u>0</u>
Subtotal (GVN Presence)	45.9	63.5	44.5	57.3	49.0	35.7
VC Control	12.7	6.1	.4	.8	3.5	0
<u>1970 "Relaxed" VSSG Indicators</u>						
GVN Control	40.0	54.9	56.9	72.8	57.8	81.9
GVN Presence - Vetoed by						
B Only	0	8.9	12.2	13.9	24.5	12.4
- Vetoed by						
C Only	16.7	10.4	5.8	.6	4.4	0
- Vetoed by B & C	<u>4.4</u>	<u>8.3</u>	<u>18.2</u>	<u>3.4</u>	<u>1.0</u>	<u>0</u>
Subtotal (GVN Presence)	61.1	82.5	93.1	90.7	87.7	94.3
VC Control	12.7	6.1	.4	0	3.5	0
<u>1967-69 HES</u>						
A - B Security	53.4	57.6	55.7	69.5	53.4	87.1
<u>1970 HES</u>						
A - B Security	<u>27.0</u>	<u>67.2</u>	<u>49.9</u>	<u>80.3</u>	<u>62.1</u>	<u>92.4</u>

PROPOSED VSSG INDICATOR DATABASED ON RURAL POPULATION - DECEMBER 1969

	<u>Total VSSG</u> <u>Prov's</u>	<u>Other</u> <u>Prov's</u>	<u>SVN</u>
<u>1967-69 VSSG Indicators</u>			
GVN Control	58.7	63.3	61.6
VC Control	8.6	6.4	7.2
<u>1970 "Strict" VSSG Indicators</u>			
GVN Control	<u>33.3</u>	<u>38.6</u>	<u>36.7</u>
GVN Presence - Vetoed by B Only	4.3	3.3	3.7
- Vetoed by C Only	5.7	6.0	5.9
- Vetoed by B and C	<u>2.5</u>	<u>1.6</u>	<u>1.9</u>
Subtotal (GVN Presence)	45.8	49.5	48.2
VC Control	10.5	9.4	9.8
<u>1970 "Relaxed" VSSG Indicators</u>			
GVN Control	45.0	49.4	47.8
GVN Presence - Vetoed by B Only	11.1	9.0	9.8
- Vetoed by C Only	7.6	9.9	9.1
- Vetoed by B and C	<u>5.1</u>	<u>3.9</u>	<u>4.3</u>
Subtotal (GVN Presence)	68.8	72.2	71.0
VC Control	10.0	9.4	9.6
<u>1967-69 HES</u>			
A - B Security	52.6	60.8	57.7
<u>1970 HES</u>			
A - B Security	<u>53.5</u>	<u>55.9</u>	<u>55.0</u>

VSSG PROVINCE RANKS UNDER VARIOUS INDICATORS
Based on December, 1969

<u>Province</u>	<u>Old VSSG GVN Control</u>	<u>New VSSG-GVN Control</u>		<u>HES A-B Security Rating</u>	
		<u>Strict Criteria</u>	<u>Relaxed Criteria</u>	<u>Old HES</u>	<u>HES/70</u>
Thua Thien	3	2	2	2	2
Quang Nam	7	7	7	3	8
Kontum	4	9	4	5	7
Binh Dinh	9	10	11	9	6
Khanh Hoa	1	5	1	1	1
Binh Thuan	12	11	10	12	10
Binh Duong	2	3	3	6	4
Long An	10	4	6	8	5
Dinh Tuong	11	12	12	10	11
Kien Hoa	8	6	9	11	9
Chuong Thien	6	8	8	6	12
Chau Doc	5	1	5	4	3
No of Provinces Having Same Rank Under Old VSSG GVN Control Indicator:					
Off by 1 Rank:		1	4	4	2
Off by 2 Ranks:		5	4	4	3
Off by 3 or More Ranks:		6	8	8	5
		2	3	1	3
		8	11	9	8
		4	1	3	4
		12	12	12	12

HES/70 VSSG CONTROL INDICATORS

GVN Control

Group A - GVN Presence (All Required)

1. Local security forces conduct at least "marginal" security operations in daytime (e.g. patrols, ambushes, listening posts, checkpoints, etc.), or operations not needed (no enemy threat). HQC2 = 1,2,3

2. As above for night operations.
HQC3 = 1,2,3

3. GVN hamlet chief regularly present day and night in hamlet. HQE2 = 3

4. GVN administrative personnel can move about with relative freedom during daylight hours in areas containing 91-100% of hamlet households. HQC5 = 0, 1

5. Some or all of Village Council members are elected. VQE2 = 2,3,4,5

Group B - Quarterly VC Veto Conditions (One or More Can Veto GVN Control)

1. Regular covert, sporadic overt activity by hamlet VCI; or hamlet VCI are primary authority in hamlet, at least at night. HQB1 = 2,3,4

2. Enemy agents, recruiters, tax collectors, etc. have access at night to 41-100% of hamlet households. HQC4 = 3,4

Group C - Hamlet Monthly VC Veto Conditions (One or More Can Veto GVN Control)

1. VC physically control the hamlet.
HMB1 = 1,2

2. Armed enemy forces present more than once in hamlet this month. HMB4 = 2,3

Group D - Village Monthly VC Veto Condition

1. Company or more of enemy main/local forces present in or near inhabited areas of village this month. VMB1 = 3,4

VC Control

Group V - VC Presence (One or More Required; GVN Presence Prohibited)

1. VC physically control the hamlet.
HMB1 = 1,2

2. Hamlet VCI are primary authority in hamlet, at least at night. HQB1 = 3,4

3. Regular covert, sporadic overt activity by hamlet VCI (HQB1 = 2), and either of the following conditions hold:

a. Friendly local security activities are not conducted at all at night. HQC3 = 0

b. Friendly local security forces conduct only marginal security operations at night, and GVN daytime access is denied to 10% or more of hamlet households. HQC3 = 1 and HQC5 = 2,3,4

Group Z - GVN Veto Conditions (One or More Can Veto VC Control)

1. Local security forces conduct "adequate" security operations in daytime. HQC2 = 2,3

2. As above for night operations.
HQC3 = 2,3

3. GVN hamlet chief regularly present day and night in hamlet. HQE2 = 3

4. GVN administrative personnel can move about with relative freedom during daylight hours in areas containing 91-100% of hamlet households. HQC5 = 0,1

Group N - Could Not Be Rated

One or more of the HES questions used in Groups A,B,C,D,V or Z were rated "not applicable" or "unknown/unable to judge" for three or more months.

Note that if a question is unanswered for only one or two months, the most recent response (two or three months old) is used.